Computer Ethics and Cyber Security



Learning Objectives

After learning this chapter, the students will be able to

- To know about cyber-crimes.
- To understand the guidelines and need for ethics in cyber-world.
- To understand issues related to cyber-crimes.
- To know the functionality of firewalls and proxy servers.
- To learn about encryption and decryption.
- To gain knowledge on IT Act.

17.1 INTRODUCTION

Internet is a communication media which is easily accessible and open to all. Information Technology is widespread through computers, mobile phones and internet. There is a lot of scope and possibility for misuse of Information Technology.

Computer systems in general are vulnerable.Special care must be taken explicitly in order to ensure that the valuable data do not get into wrong hands. Hence, the data need to be protected.

A cyber-crime is a crime which involves computer and network.This is becoming a growing threat to society .

ETHICS

Ethics is a set of moral principles that govern the behavior of an individual in a society, and Computer ethics is set of moral principles that regulate the use of computers by users.

GUIDELINES OF ETHICS

Generally, the following guidelines should be observed by computer users:

1. **Honesty:** Users should be truthful while using the internet.
2. **Confidentiality:** Users should not share any important information with unauthorized people.
3. **Respect:** Each user should respect the privacy of other users.
4. **Responsibility:** Each user should take ownership and responsibility for their actions



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17.2 ETHICAL ISSUES

An Ethical issue is a problem or issue that requires a person or organization to choose between alternatives that must be evaluated as right (ethical) or wrong (unethical). These issues must be addressed and resolved to have a positive influence in society.

Some of the common ethical issues are listed below:

- Cyber crime
- Software Piracy
- Hacking
- Use of computers to commit fraud

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